



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Three Oaks Christian School

School Website: <https://threeoakscs.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Three Oaks Christian School (Decatur, IN, 46733) presents public materials that are not accessible at the moment due to an active site error (the crawl content for the site returns a Cloudflare 500 error), so there is no verifiable textual evidence from the school's website to support Classical or anti-Classical signals across the six rubric categories. The crawl evidence is limited to an error page indicating the site is unreachable at this time. This absence of accessible site content prevents a positive confirmation of the full Classical approach (e.g., Great Books engagement, Trivium-based pedagogy, liturgical practices, Great Conversation, and explicit formation aims) from the public-facing materials that would ordinarily be used to score. Given the lack of accessible site content, all six categories are rated NOT CLASSICAL based on the Public Materials criterion in the Classical rubric, recognizing that a future update from the school could alter the assessment if it makes explicit Classical features public.

Public-facing material availability and accessibility: - The crawl shows the site URL (threeoakscs.org) but currently returns a 500 error, with no substantive curricular or community content available for evaluation.

Notes on rubric sources: - The Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) document defines the six categories and provides the Positive/Negative keyword indicators that guide scoring (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; School Purpose and Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community). The document outlines the presence of key terms and practices (eg, truth, beauty, virtue; theology; liturgical practices; Great Books; Great Conversation; Socratic pedagogy; scholé; worship; partnership with families; etc.). These indicators serve as the scoring framework once site material is available for analysis. See definitions and keyword lists in the Six Essential Elements documents.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **NOT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Public site content is not accessible due to a 500 error, so no explicit statements about transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgical practice, or communal worship could be validated from the site at this time.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- The Classical rubric identifies favorable indicators such as truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; and communal worship as markers of Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The current crawl contains no accessible textual material to confirm these keywords on the site. Therefore, present

signals are 0 positive and 0 negative keyword hits within the school's public materials (due to inaccessibility). See the keyword framework in the Six Essential Elements document (Positive/Negative keyword panels for this category).

- Why this rating
- Without accessible site text in the public materials, there is no verifiable evidence of transcendental foundations, theological grounding, or liturgical/community practices on the website. The 500 error blocks confirmation of these signals. Accordingly, NOT CLASSICAL for this category pending future public content.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- No accessible site statements about aims such as formation of virtue and wisdom over job preparation, or the contemplation of truth, goodness, and beauty. The crawl shows a site error rather than content to verify these aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators in the rubric include formation, virtue, contemplation, telos, scholé, and the pursuit of true, good, and beautiful. No site text is available to confirm these terms publicly. Thus 0 positive, 0 negative keyword hits from the crawl. The rubric's keyword lists define these concepts; see the related sections in the Six Essential Elements document.
- Why this rating
- Absence of public-facing statements about formation-based aims or a classical telos results in a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category until such content is publicly accessible on the site.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- No accessible site content confirming the presence of liberal arts foundations (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, or the Great Conversation; nor explicit statements about history as a through-line and not merely "social studies." The current crawl lacks curricular content due to the site error.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- The rubric identifies Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium; Great Books; "great conversation" as core signals. No textual presence is verifiable from the public site content in this crawl. Therefore, 0 positive keyword hits and 0 negative keyword hits for this category on the site. See the Curriculum-related keywords in the Six Essential Elements doc.
- Why this rating
- Without accessible curricular language or references on the site, there is no evidence the curriculum aligns with Classical liberal arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation). NOT CLASSICAL pending future public content.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The crawl does not reveal public statements about Socratic seminars, scholé, chanting, memorization via singing, or upper-level rhetoric/debate pedagogy. The site error prevents assessment of pedagogy signals.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- The rubric's signals include Socratic dialogue; narration; chanting; restfulness (scholé); and rhetoric training. There is no accessible site text to confirm these on the Three Oaks site; hence 0 positive and 0 negative keyword hits are identifiable from the crawl. See the Pedagogy section in the Six Essential Elements doc for reference.
- Why this rating
- With no public text to confirm or negate the specified pedagogy signals, the category is NOT CLASSICAL for now.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- No accessible statements about faculty being “model teachers” or the living curriculum, or about a faculty-as-culture approach. The crawl content is blocked by an error page.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- The Positive Keywords for Faculty include: model teachers; living curriculum; faculty of friends; collegiality; mentorship; virtuous exemplars. No such textual signals are publicly accessible on the site through the current crawl. Thus 0 positive keyword hits and 0 negative keyword hits from the crawl. See the Faculty section in the Six Essential Elements document.
- Why this rating
- Absence of public-facing faculty descriptors or portraits in accessible site content yields NOT CLASSICAL for this category at this time.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- There is no accessible site text confirming partnership with families, parental formation, or open campus visitation. The crawl shows only an error page for the domain.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords for Parents & Community include: partnership with families; parent formation; open campus; parental involvement; living tradition in the family. No public text found on the current crawl. Thus 0 positive keyword hits and 0 negative keyword hits from the crawl. See the Parents & Community section in the Six Essential Elements document.
- Why this rating
- Without accessible signals of family partnership and community formation, NOT CLASSICAL is the prudent rating for this category today.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here. The school has been rated NOT CLASSICAL across all six categories due to a lack of accessible public-facing content in the crawl. If the school publishes explicit Classical signals (e.g., Great Books and Great Conversation references; explicit Trivium pedagogy; liturgical practices; a living-teaching-faculty model; and active parental partnership statements) the rubric would warrant a re-evaluation and potential movement toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or CLASSICAL in select categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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